RESEARCH DOSSIER

Loose Change Evidence Review

What is established, what the film overstates, and which questions merit further work.

Research checked through November 6, 2026.

Several facts behind Loose Change deserve credence. The evidence reviewed does not establish its central allegations of planned demolition, substituted aircraft or a U.S.-directed attack. Its strongest material concerns warning failures, changing official accounts and weaknesses in the investigations. Those issues can be serious even when a proposed explanation for them fails.

This review treats each proposition separately: what happened, how securely it is documented, what follows from it, and what additional evidence could change the assessment. A real anomaly earns investigation; it does not automatically validate the explanation attached to it.

The most useful next work concerns documentary accountability and reproducible technical analysis. The source register and specific research questions below make those inquiries concrete. No new records requests, interviews, laboratory tests or engineering simulations were performed.

Assessment	Meaning
Established narrower fact	The observation or record is well supported. Its implications must be assessed separately.
Worth targeted follow-up	A defined gap or conflict remains, with identifiable evidence that could help resolve it.
Unsupported inference	The cited evidence does not discriminate between the proposed explanation and credible alternatives.
Contradicted premise	Specific evidence conflicts with a material part of the claim.

Scope and standards

Which Loose Change?

The film exists in substantially different editions. For claim attribution, this review checked a third-party transcript of the second edition and the distributor's timed transcript for a 52-minute version catalogued in 2015. The distributor's cut should not be mistaken for a complete transcript of every earlier release. Later technical studies and legal developments are identified as subsequent evidence. This is a review of major recurring claims, not a frame-by-frame audit of every edition. [1][2][3]

The second-edition text includes the Pentagon and Flight 93, allegedly fabricated calls, surviving hijackers, financial trades, security changes and a gold-theft narrative. The distributor's later transcript includes the Mineta testimony, red/gray dust chips, WTC 7 witnesses and lost SEC files. These anchors establish the scope without assuming that every version retained each allegation. [2][3]

How the evidence is weighed

Primary records receive priority: recordings and their transcripts, contemporaneous documents, audit findings, technical reports, court decisions and original research. Official conclusions are evidence to evaluate, not a substitute for the underlying reasoning. Conversely, a critic's institutional affiliation, credential or peer-reviewed publication does not by itself establish their conclusion.

Separate four questions: Was an observation real? Was the first explanation accurate? Does the alternative explain the complete evidence better? Is there evidence identifying responsible people and actions? Confusing these questions is the main source of overstatement in this debate.

An explanation should survive evidence it did not select: other camera angles, the full recording, transaction ownership, contemporary records and plausible competing causes. Missing records reduce confidence in what can be reconstructed. They do not tell us what those records would have shown.

1. Failures that deserve scrutiny

1.1 Warning and information-sharing failures

ESTABLISHED NARROWER FACT / TARGETED FOLLOW-UP

The August 6, 2001 presidential brief warned about a domestic bin Laden threat and described information consistent with preparations for hijacking or surveillance. It did not identify the date, flights or complete September 11 operation. A real warning and detailed advance knowledge of the particular attack are different propositions. [47]

The Justice Department inspector general documented repeated missed opportunities involving Khalid al-Mihdhar and Nawaf al-Hazmi, including failures to pass on and act on information about their U.S. connections. Its broader review also identified failures involving the Phoenix memorandum and the investigation of Zacarias Moussaoui. These findings justify serious criticism of prevention and information sharing. [46][49]

The same inspector-general review disclosed limits on its access to CIA records. The useful follow-up is to trace the original intelligence, dissemination decisions and responsibility at each missed opportunity. An institution can possess important fragments without anyone possessing the completed operational picture; proving deliberate facilitation requires evidence beyond the fact that the fragments were mishandled. [46]

1.2 The aviation response and changing timelines

ESTABLISHED NARROWER FACT / TARGETED FOLLOW-UP

The official aviation chronology changed materially. The DOT inspector general confirmed incorrect accounts of when the FAA notified the military about Flight 77 and when an Air Force liaison joined a conference call. Three executives learned that the latter account was wrong, yet the correction did not reach the Commission. The inspector general recommended considering administrative action, while finding insufficient evidence of knowingly false statements or intentional omissions. Both parts of that finding matter. [29]

This supports scrutiny of accuracy and accountability. It does not establish that fighters were deliberately held back to permit the attacks. To evaluate that stronger claim, the relevant evidence is the recorded sequence of notification, identification, tasking and authorization, not the time elapsed since the first television broadcast.

A separate DOT inspector-general investigation established that an FAA manager destroyed a tape containing six controllers' same-day recollections, contrary to retention requirements. This was a supplemental witness-account tape, not the original operational air-traffic recordings. Its existence was also kept out of the evidence package. This is a documented evidence-preservation failure; the report does not establish an order from senior government officials to destroy it. [31]

1.3 Steel preservation and access to building records

ESTABLISHED FAILURE; MOTIVE NOT ESTABLISHED

The March 6, 2002 House hearing documents steel recycled before adequate examination, unclear authority to preserve evidence, and delays obtaining drawings. Investigators disagreed about how much this impaired the eventual explanation; the hearing does not support saying that no steel was examined. These are substantive failures, recorded publicly by Congress. [4]

The warranted inference is that some opportunities for forensic examination were irreversibly lost. Deliberate concealment requires additional evidence of intent. A useful inquiry would reconstruct who authorized disposal, which material was screened and retained, and which specific questions the losses made unanswerable. Rescue urgency and evidence preservation both belong in that assessment.

1.4 Limits on the Commission and destroyed interrogation records

ESTABLISHED LIMITATIONS / TARGETED FOLLOW-UP

The 9/11 Commission itself disclosed that its account of plot planning relied heavily on detainee interrogation reports, while it could not interview detainees or their interrogators directly. It submitted questions without controlling how they were asked. This materially limits confidence in details resting on that reporting alone. It does not erase independently documented travel, communications, recordings or physical evidence. [5]

Commission chairs Thomas Kean and Lee Hamilton later described the CIA's failure to disclose interrogation tapes as obstruction. They identified the recorded detainees as Abu Zubaydah and Abd al-Rahim al-Nashiri. Senate records document destruction in November 2005. These were not recordings of Khalid Sheikh Mohammed's account of planning 9/11. Their loss limits scrutiny of those interrogations; it does not establish an alternative cause of the attacks. [6][7]

The productive follow-up is a proposition-level audit: identify which claims depend on coercive interrogation, then identify their independent corroboration, contradictions and remaining gaps. Treat uncorroborated intelligence assertions with less confidence than contemporaneous records.

1.5 Saudi-linked assistance: a serious later inquiry

LIVE EVIDENTIARY DISPUTE; NO FINAL LIABILITY FINDING

This is important subsequent evidence, not validation of the film's demolition or aircraft-substitution claims. In August 2025 a federal district court found sufficient support for the jurisdictional case involving Omar al-Bayoumi, Fahad al-Thumairy and assistance to hijackers to reject Saudi Arabia's dismissal motion. Its reasoning addresses evidence of employment, contacts and assistance; it is more substantial than a bare allegation, but it is not a final judgment that the Saudi state directed or knowingly supported the attacks. [9]

There is a material counterpoint: the FBI's May 2021 Operation Encore closing memorandum said the evidence was insufficient to prosecute a knowing conspiracy and closed the inquiry, with reopening possible if new information emerged. Criminal charging and civil jurisdiction apply different standards and may consider different records. Neither result should be substituted for the other. [8]

Reporting on the October 7, 2026 appeals hearing described the sovereign-immunity decision as pending. This review did not verify a subsequent disposition. Saudi Arabia denies involvement. Priority should go to the original exhibits, financial and communication records, witness reliability and what changed between the FBI's assessment and the later litigation. [10]

1.6 Mineta's testimony and military exercises

AUTHENTIC TESTIMONY; STAND-DOWN INTERPRETATION UNPROVEN

Norman Mineta really testified about an aide asking Cheney whether orders still stood as an aircraft approached. In the same hearing, Mineta said he inferred a shootdown order, rather than testifying that he heard an order to let an aircraft strike. His stated timing conflicts with the Commission's later placement of Cheney in the shelter conference room shortly before 10:00. The Commission acknowledged conflicting arrival evidence. This is a real chronology problem, not a documented admission of a stand-down. [32][5]

The Commission also records the initial military question about whether the FAA call was real or an exercise, followed by clarification that it was real. That exchange supports momentary uncertainty; it does not establish that an exercise disabled the response. Evaluation should follow the full operational recordings and tasking sequence, while keeping later recollections distinct from contemporaneous records. [5]

2. Buildings and physical evidence

2.1 Jet fuel, steel and the towers

MELTING ARGUMENT DOES NOT ESTABLISH DEMOLITION

Steel need not melt to lose load-bearing capacity. NIST's tower explanation combines aircraft damage, damage to fire protection and subsequent fire-driven deformation; it identifies inward bowing of perimeter columns and collapse initiation at the impact/fire floors. The argument that jet fuel cannot melt structural steel therefore does not rebut the mechanism actually proposed. [13]

NIST's detailed tower modeling addressed initiation rather than simulating every stage of debris movement to the ground. That is a limit on the scope of the model, not an admission that gravity could not propagate failure. Claims based on apparent collapse speed or dust jets need synchronized measurements of the actual structure; a dust front or first falling exterior panel is not automatically a measure of the entire building's descent. [13]

2.2 WTC 7's free fall

REAL OBSERVATION / NON-UNIQUE EXPLANATION

NIST's final report acknowledges approximately 2.25 seconds of gravitational acceleration in the descent of the north face, within a longer, three-stage motion. The measurement concerns a visible part of the collapse, not proof that the entire failure process occurred in uninterrupted free fall. [11]

That interval implies negligible net support for the descending section. It does not by itself identify the mechanism that removed the support. NIST's proposed sequence involves internal failures preceding the exterior descent. A demolition explanation must establish its own causal sequence and account for the preceding internal motion, timing and physical evidence. [11]

It is reasonable to demand that a structural explanation account for this measurement. It is not reasonable to treat the measurement alone as identification of explosives. That distinction follows from mechanics: acceleration describes the resulting forces, not the historical process that produced them.

2.3 WTC 7 models, transparency and the Alaska study

WORTH REPRODUCIBLE TECHNICAL FOLLOW-UP

NIST attributes WTC 7's initiation to fire-driven floor-system failures around Column 79. A later University of Alaska Fairbanks study led by J. Leroy Hulsey disputes fire as the cause and argues for near-simultaneous column failures. The university identifies Architects & Engineers for 9/11 Truth as the funder and offers the model data. This is an identifiable competing engineering study whose specific claims can be tested. Funding is relevant context; the calculations must still be judged on their merits. [11][24]

There is a legitimate transparency issue: NIST acknowledges withholding specified model input and result files, citing public safety. Independent reproduction is harder when essential inputs are unavailable. Neither that restriction nor the existence of a dissenting model establishes demolition. [12]

My assessment: transparency and specific contrary claims warrant an independently reproducible comparison; the existence of a dissenting study does not put the explanations on equal evidentiary footing. The UAF project summary was examined, but its large final-report download exceeded the retrieval tool's limit. I have not independently rerun either model or adjudicated every connection calculation. [24]

2.4 Dust chips and the nanothermite claim

PUBLISHED CLAIM; DEMOLITION INFERENCE UNESTABLISHED

Harrit and colleagues published a 2009 paper interpreting red/gray dust chips as unreacted thermitic material, based on microscopy, elemental analysis and heating tests. The paper documents privately collected samples and acknowledges that heating in air could add energy from oxidation of organic material. Thus the observation of a heat-releasing reaction alone does not uniquely establish a thermite reaction. [25]

James Millette's 2012 laboratory report examined visually and elementally similar chips from different dust samples and identified an epoxy coating with iron oxide and kaolin, without detecting elemental aluminum. It also acknowledged that the exact commercial source was undetermined. Because the samples differed, this does not prove that every chip in Harrit's work was identical paint; it does show why appearance and elemental ingredients are not a sufficient identification. [26]

The useful test is a blinded, shared-sample replication with documented custody, reference coatings and energetic materials, mineral-phase identification and controlled-atmosphere calorimetry. Even confirming an energetic material would leave separate questions about its amount, origin, placement and causal role. NIST did not perform residue tests for thermite or explosives; that omission is real, but is not a positive detection. [13]

2.5 FEMA's unusual steel and reports of molten material

REAL OBSERVATIONS WITH LIMITED DIAGNOSTIC VALUE

FEMA Appendix C documented unusual oxidation, sulfidation and localized intergranular melting in two steel samples. It explicitly left the sulfur source, corrosion rate and whether the damage developed before collapse or during prolonged heating afterward unresolved. Calling this observation fictional would be wrong. Calling it proof of thermate would also go beyond the report. [27]

The first sample's building attribution was tentative in the introduction, and its original structural location was unknown. That limits what it can demonstrate about collapse initiation. The authors called for further study. A useful follow-up would trace the retained specimens, subsequent analyses and realistic sulfur-bearing exposure conditions. [27]

Reports or images of glowing or flowing material require composition, location and timing before they can establish molten structural steel or a specific incendiary. The same standard applies to confident alternative identifications: an untested image cannot conclusively identify an alloy. Evidence from the debris pile after collapse must also be distinguished from evidence of the initiating event.

2.6 Explosions, witnesses and 'pull it'

TESTIMONY DESERVES CONTEXT; A DEVICE IS NOT IDENTIFIED

The examined film transcript includes WTC 7 witnesses describing explosions and damage during their escape. Those experiences deserve to be taken seriously. The description of an explosion does not, by itself, identify a planted explosive: establishing a source requires reliable timing, location, recordings and physical evidence. This review did not independently synchronize each witness account, including Barry Jennings's, against the tower collapses and other events. It therefore does not claim every account has been individually explained. [2]

Larry Silverstein's phrase "pull it" is real. A BBC Trust editorial record reports his subsequent explanation that he meant withdrawing firefighters. That is evidence of his stated meaning, not independent proof of every operational detail. I did not acquire the unedited original interview. The phrase alone does not establish that demolition equipment had been installed or that he ordered its activation. The full interview and contemporaneous fire-command records are the appropriate evidence for the narrower dispute. [28]

3. Aircraft, calls and identities

3.1 The Pentagon aircraft

AIRCRAFT-SUBSTITUTION CLAIM CONTRADICTED BY COMBINED EVIDENCE

The aircraft claim must be assessed against positive evidence. The NTSB flight-path study combined the recovered Flight 77 flight-data recorder with several radar sources and reconstructed its approach to the Pentagon. The ASCE building-performance investigation, summarized by NIST, examined extensive structural damage, building plans, aircraft information and witness accounts. These sources describe a damaging aircraft impact, rather than inferring one merely from the government's announcement. [33][34]

The Defense Department's published Pentagon history also records recovered aircraft fragments and both flight recorders; the flight-data recorder yielded useful information, while the cockpit voice recorder did not. A claim that there was no aircraft wreckage or no recovered flight recorder is contradicted by those records. [35]

An unclear security-camera image cannot by itself distinguish a missile from a large aircraft. The stronger substitution claim needs to explain the radar, recorder provenance, wreckage and damage together. The reviewed evidence supports Flight 77 striking the Pentagon. This is an assessment of converging records, not a new independent authentication of every recovered component.

3.2 Flight 93 and a shootdown or substitute landing

CLAIM NOT SUPPORTED BY THE CRASH RECORD

The crash record includes recovered aircraft wreckage and both flight recorders. The Justice Department's artifact collection identifies a fuselage fragment carrying cockpit number 5491 as evidence used to identify the aircraft. The published cockpit-voice transcript records a struggle and commands to put the aircraft down. Together these are substantial positive evidence against a substituted landing and are consistent with the hijackers crashing the aircraft during the passenger assault. [36][37][38]

There was dispersed debris: the National Park Service distinguishes light material found as far away as New Baltimore from larger wreckage at the crash site. It also reports no evidence of explosives there. Distant paper is not equivalent to a heavy component separating in flight. Conversely, dismissing every distant-debris report as a road-distance error would be inaccurate. Material, weight, location, timing and wind conditions matter. [36]

This review read the released transcript, not the sealed original cockpit audio. A shootdown hypothesis would need evidence such as weapon fragments, a matching engagement record or a flight-data discontinuity attributable to a weapon. The reviewed records do not provide that evidence. [50]

3.3 Phone calls and voice fabrication

TECHNOLOGICAL POSSIBILITY IS NOT EVENT EVIDENCE

The claim that airborne phone calls were impossible depends heavily on confusing ordinary mobile phones with the aircraft's installed Airfones. The National Park Service's source-based Flight 93 record identifies 35 Airfone calls among 37 calls, with billing evidence introduced at the Moussaoui trial. It distinguishes actual recordings from witnesses' later recollections of conversations. [30]

This materially undermines a wholesale fabricated-calls theory. Voice imitation being technically possible does not establish that these calls were fabricated. A persuasive challenge would have to explain the billing records, recipient accounts and contemporaneous reporting together. Particular disputes about one call's device, duration or wording should be evaluated individually; they cannot erase the rest of the record by association.

3.4 Alleged surviving hijackers

EARLY IDENTITY REPORTS DO NOT ESTABLISH SURVIVAL

The FBI's first public list was issued on September 14, 2001 with uneven identification details, aliases and alternative dates of birth. Early reporting should not be treated as a flawless identification record. But finding a living person with the same or a similar name does not establish that the person later identified by photograph, travel history and other evidence survived. [48]

Later FBI forensic reporting describes DNA profiles developed for several hijackers from crash-site and hotel-room items; it does not claim that all nineteen were identified by DNA. The evidentiary record therefore extends beyond a list of names. [51]

This review did not complete a person-by-person audit of every alleged survivor or obtain the original BBC correction page. Accordingly, its conclusion is bounded: the early same-name reports do not establish survival of the identified attackers. Any serious renewed claim should match the person across photographs, birth details, documents and movements, then address the later identification evidence.

4. Money and foreknowledge

4.1 Options trades before the attacks

REAL STATISTICAL QUESTION; FOREKNOWLEDGE NOT ESTABLISHED

There was a legitimate reason to investigate. Allen Poteshman's 2006 peer-reviewed study found unusually high long-put buying before the attacks, consistent with informed trading; its volume-ratio measures did not yield the same conclusion. A statistical signal is therefore not imaginary, but its interpretation depends on the measure and benchmark. The study did not identify perpetrators or establish the information behind a particular trade. [39]

The SEC reported examining more than 9.5 million transactions and finding no evidence of attack-foreknowledge trading. The Commission's financing monograph gives a concrete example: an adviser responsible for 95% of United's September 6 put volume also bought substantial American shares on September 10 and described a broader airline strategy. Investigators considered that fuller portfolio as well as the trader's identity. [40][41]

The published account-level findings weigh against attack foreknowledge. Independent scrutiny would be stronger if flagged trades could be reconciled with the released investigative workpapers, beneficial ownership, offsetting positions and contemporaneously documented reasons. An unusual pattern should not be described as proof of foreknowledge.

4.2 The Pentagon's $2.3 trillion

REAL ACCOUNTING FAILURE; NOT EVIDENCE THAT $2.3 TRILLION VANISHED

The $2.3 trillion figure referred to accounting entries unsupported by adequate documentation or audit trails, not an identified $2.3 trillion cash balance that vanished. A May 9, 2000 congressional hearing already discussed the figure in reviewing fiscal 1999 Defense Department accounts. The problem therefore predates September 10, 2001 and was already public. [42]

Unsupported adjustments are a severe control and audit problem: they can conceal errors and make misuse harder to detect. Their gross total is not itself a calculation of stolen money, since accounting entries can move, reconcile or reclassify the same underlying amounts. Showing that a subsequent attack destroyed the evidence of a particular theft would require identifying that theft and the relevant records; the coincidence of a speech and the attack does not do so.

4.3 Silverstein's insurance

INSURANCE AND LITIGATION ARE REAL; MOTIVE ALONE PROVES NOTHING

The insurance and ensuing litigation were real. The Second Circuit's 2003 opinion records that the WTC lease required insurance, that roughly $3.5 billion of coverage per occurrence was arranged, and that actual property loss substantially exceeded that amount. The litigation concerned how differing policy and binder language treated the two aircraft impacts. [45]

This gives the purchase and dispute an ordinary contractual context. It does not establish a deliberately engineered windfall. A gross insurance recovery is not a calculation of net profit: acquisition costs, property losses, debt and rebuilding obligations must be considered. Evidence of foreknowledge would require a documented connection to the attack, beyond buying required insurance and arguing for coverage after the loss.

4.4 Operation Northwoods and PNAC

AUTHENTIC CONTEXT; NO DOCUMENTED BRIDGE TO EXECUTION OF 9/11

Operation Northwoods was real. The March 1962 Joint Chiefs memorandum proposed manufactured pretexts for intervention in Cuba, including staged attacks and an aircraft deception. It is direct evidence that senior officials proposed such methods. The document is a planning submission, not evidence that its proposals were executed on September 11, 2001. [43]

PNAC's 2000 report also really used the phrase 'new Pearl Harbor' while discussing how a catastrophe could accelerate military transformation. The surrounding passage concerns procurement, institutional change and the pace of transformation. It supplies evidence of a strategic worldview, not an operational instruction to carry out 9/11. [44]

Historical precedent and potential political benefit can inform hypotheses. Establishing this particular operation requires a documented bridge: people, instructions, resources, implementation and corroborating records. These texts do not supply that bridge.

5. Specific claims that change under scrutiny

5.1 Security was reduced and bomb dogs were removed

NARROW REPORT IS REAL; BROADER ABSENCE CLAIM FAILS

A contemporary Newsday report quoted security guard Daria Coard saying that extended shifts following telephone threats had ended and bomb-sniffing dogs had been removed the preceding Thursday. The original newspaper archive was not acquired; its republished text was examined. This supports a reported reduction in an extra security deployment, without establishing every entrance, shift or canine assignment. [14]

The 9/11 Memorial Museum's accession record documents bomb-detection dog Sirius with Officer David Lim in the South Tower basement that morning. Therefore a claim that there were no bomb dogs at the WTC is false. The useful remaining questions concern the actual staffing changes, their authorization and the threat assessment behind them. Rosters and canine deployment logs could resolve those questions; the article alone cannot. [15]

5.2 The BBC reported WTC 7's collapse prematurely

REAL REPORTING ERROR; FOREKNOWLEDGE INFERENCE UNSUPPORTED

The premature report is real. Reporting tracing the BBC's explanation identifies an erroneous Reuters account, subsequently withdrawn, amid warnings that the building might collapse. The original BBC blog pages were inaccessible in this review, and the original Reuters dispatch and withdrawal were not independently acquired. That limits verification of the precise transmission chain. [23]

An early report of an anticipated event is compatible with a newsroom converting a warning into a statement that it has happened. To establish advance operational knowledge, the necessary evidence would be an authenticated source chain containing information unavailable from public warnings. Repeatedly replaying the same error does not provide that evidence.

5.3 Willie Brown and John Ashcroft received special warnings

NARROW FACTS; SPECIFIC-ATTACK FOREKNOWLEDGE NOT SHOWN

The contemporaneous Willie Brown story describes a routine warning from airport security that did not deter his planned trip. It does not identify Condoleezza Rice as the caller or document warning of the particular attack. A claim attributing the call to Rice needs a separate original record. [16]

Ashcroft testified that official travel on government aircraft followed personal-protection advice, while he continued personal commercial travel, including on September 3. That is his sworn account, not an independently reconstructed travel ledger. The available testimony does not establish that he stopped commercial travel because he knew about 9/11. His underlying threat assessment and travel records would be the appropriate tests. [17]

5.4 A CIA officer met bin Laden at a Dubai hospital

PUBLISHED ALLEGATION; NOT VERIFIED

Contemporary reporting confirms that Le Figaro published the allegation, relying on an anonymous source. It also records denials from the CIA and the hospital. The existence of a newspaper report establishes that the allegation circulated; it does not establish the meeting. No authenticated medical, travel or meeting record was found in this review. [21][22]

This merits reconsideration if a source supplies a verifiable contemporaneous document or an identifiable firsthand witness. Without that, it should receive little evidentiary weight. A denial alone would not settle the matter, but an uncorroborated accusation does not settle it either.

5.5 Gold disappeared from the WTC vaults

THE LARGE-THEFT NARRATIVE LACKS AN AUTHENTICATED INVENTORY

Reuters reported in November 2001 that the NYBOT and ScotiaMocatta announced recovery and relocation of all metals in their 4 WTC depository to an approved Brinks facility, with the metal available for futures delivery. That is a named institutional recovery claim, not a new independent audit of every possible WTC holding. [20]

The film's much larger gold figure is not established by a verified pre-attack inventory. Comparing an unsupported total with a reported recovery amount cannot demonstrate a theft. A serious investigation would require vault-specific ownership and bar lists, delivery warrants, carrier records and reconciled quantities. A photograph of recovered metal in a vehicle does not supply the missing inventory. [3]

5.6 WTC 7's destruction erased SEC investigations

PHYSICAL LOSSES WERE REAL; TOTAL ERASURE IS CONTRADICTED

The SEC lost its regional office. But Chairman Harvey Pitt told Congress on September 20, 2001 that its electronically stored documents had been recovered and that cases were being reviewed and reconstructed. The SEC inspector general also described evidence recovery from backups and original sources, while acknowledging disruption. [18][19]

These records contradict the suggestion that destruction of the building necessarily eliminated all records of its investigations. They do not prove that every paper file or evidentiary item was recovered. A worthwhile narrower question is which cases suffered irrecoverable losses and whether case outcomes changed for that reason. That requires case-level loss and reconstruction records.

6. The most useful next research

These are ranked by evidentiary value and the chance that identifiable records could improve the answer. They are recommendations for further research, not claims that those records have already been obtained.

Priority 1: Reconstruct warning and response accountability

Build one timeline from dated CIA/FBI dissemination records, FAA/NORAD recordings, interview dates, the successive official narratives and inspector-general findings. For each discrepancy record who knew what, at what time, and which underlying record supports it. This distinguishes operational mistakes, later inaccurate recollections and knowing misstatements. The most consequential discovery would be a contemporaneous instruction or documented suppression that survives comparison with independent records.

Priority 2: Examine the Saudi assistance evidence at exhibit level

Start with the 2025 court decision and exhibits concerning Bayoumi, Thumairy, employment and payments, then compare them with the 2021 Encore closing assessment and later releases. Separate an actual contact or payment from an inference about its purpose. Identify what each witness personally observed. Follow the appeal for procedural status without treating a jurisdictional decision as a verdict on responsibility. [8][9][10]

Priority 3: Test specific WTC 7 claims with reproducible models

Use the same documented geometry, connection details, fire assumptions and video time base to compare competing models. Publish inputs, sensitivity ranges, failure criteria and predictions before matching the complete observed sequence. Ask which conclusion changes when an uncertain input changes, and whether either model predicts observations it was not fitted to. A model that reproduces descent after prescribed support removal has not yet explained what removed those supports.

Request a precise inventory of withheld NIST files and pursue technically useful access arrangements where appropriate. NIST acknowledges withholding some model files on public-safety grounds. That is a real reproducibility issue; withholding alone says nothing about whether the files would favor the official or an alternative explanation. [12]

Priority 4: Audit evidence preservation and interrogation dependence

For steel, documents and recordings, reconstruct custody, retention and disposal decisions and identify the questions each loss prevents answering. For plot-planning claims, map interrogation-derived assertions to genuinely independent corroboration. This produces a confidence assessment for individual propositions. [4][5][6][31]

Priority 5: Reconcile trading studies with traced transactions

Replicate statistical results with predeclared time windows, comparable control periods, corrections for multiple searches and full strategy-level positions. Then match flagged trades, where lawful records permit, to ownership, offsets and contemporaneous reasons. An unusual market pattern, evidence of advance knowledge, and participation in planning the attacks are three different propositions. Identity and transaction documentation are the discriminating evidence.

Lower priority without new evidence

Recycling ambiguous phrases, compressed news clips, alleged same-name survivors, low-quality impact frames or unsupported inventory figures is unlikely to advance the inquiry. These topics should move up the queue only when new authenticated records address the specific evidentiary gap.

Limits and overall assessment

What this review establishes

There is a substantial documented basis for criticizing preparedness, information sharing, some official representations and evidence preservation. There are also technical uncertainties that justify transparent review. Those conclusions do not depend on accepting the film's most dramatic claims.

The aircraft and demolition allegations need positive, coherent evidence of their own. A genuine failure in one investigation cannot fill an evidentiary gap in another subject. The strongest overall reading of the reviewed record remains an al-Qaeda attack amid serious failures of prevention and response, followed by documented shortcomings in investigation and accountability. Claims of an alternative execution mechanism are not established here. [33][37][46][52]

This review did not rerun engineering models, authenticate original broadcast tapes or examine physical samples. It did not independently audit every financial transaction, assess every released intelligence file or watch every edition frame by frame. Some primary pages were inaccessible, and those limitations are stated at the affected claims. Current legal status is based on the latest material located, not a guarantee that no later docket entry exists.

Give credence to the supported facts, calibrate confidence in explanations, and pursue records capable of distinguishing competing accounts. That approach preserves the legitimate questions without granting unsupported conclusions more weight than their evidence warrants.

Source register

Numbers in the text link to this register. Source titles below open the original or identified mirror. Page numbers are printed page numbers unless explicitly described as PDF pages. Entries distinguish firsthand records, official interpretations, research papers and reporting.

[1] **Journeyman Pictures: Loose Change catalogue**. Distributor record, reference 6593, dated October 9, 2015; duration 52 minutes. Primary source for the identity of the examined distributor version.

[2] **Loose Change: distributor's timed transcript**. Primary film-attribution source for the 52-minute version. Relevant segments include Mineta at approximately 25:45-27:08; dust chips at 31:10-34:10; SEC files at 41:58-42:09; WTC 7 witnesses at 45:25-46:40.

[3] **Loose Change 2nd Edition transcript**. Third-party transcription used for identifying claims, not as evidence those claims are true. No claim is made that this is an authenticated production script or a transcript of Final Cut.

[4] **House hearing: Learning from 9/11 - Understanding the Collapse of the World Trade Center**. March 6, 2002, serial 107-46. Primary hearing record. See charter pp. 11-12; testimony and exchanges pp. 131-134 and 181-190 on steel disposal and access to drawings.

[5] **The 9/11 Commission Report**. 2004. Primary commission report. Printed p. 146 explains detainee-access limitations. Chapter 1 gives the reconstructed aviation and White House chronology and acknowledges conflicting evidence about Cheney's arrival in the shelter conference room. Underlying evidentiary citations remain essential.

[6] **Senate Intelligence Committee material on destruction of CIA interrogation tapes**. 2014 Senate report excerpt hosted by the National Security Archive. Primary scanned pages, especially printed pp. 443-444, inspected visually. Documents November 2005 destruction; this is not evidence about the physical crash or collapse mechanisms.

[7] **Kean and Hamilton: CIA obstruction of the 9/11 panel**. January 3, 2008. Firsthand commentary by the Commission's chair and vice-chair, republished by the Houston Chronicle. Their assessment of nondisclosure, rather than a judicial finding.

[8] **FBI Operation Encore closing memorandum and addendum**. May 27, 2021 closing communication, with September 8, 2021 addendum. EO 14040 release, stamps EO14040-000001 onward. See closing memorandum pp. 10-11 for charging assessment and closure. The addendum corrects the interview count; do not repeat the uncorrected total.

[9] **In re Terrorist Attacks: August 28, 2025 opinion, document 11182**. S.D.N.Y., 03-md-01570. Primary 45-page opinion; key scanned pages inspected, including pp. 12, 30 and 44-45. Denies Saudi Arabia's dismissal motion at the jurisdictional stage; not a final merits judgment.

[10] **ABC News: 9/11 families' Saudi appeal hearing**. Aaron Katersky, Lucien Bruggeman and Bill Hutchinson, October 7, 2026. Reporting used for current appellate status and the Saudi denial, not as proof of the underlying allegations.

[11] **NIST NCSTAR 1A: Final Report on the Collapse of WTC 7**. November 2008. Primary technical report. See section 3.6 and principal findings, especially printed p. 48, on three-stage descent and the approximately 2.25-second interval; the report presents a probable failure sequence.

[12] **NIST WTC 7 investigation FAQs**. Official explanatory source, updated September 10, 2021. Question 7 addresses withheld model files and the stated statutory rationale; question 32 explains the roofline measurement. Interpretive agency source, not independent replication.

[13] **NIST WTC towers investigation FAQs**. Official explanatory source, updated September 10, 2021. Questions 28-31 distinguish collapse initiation, residue testing and collapse timing. Question 29 explicitly acknowledges that steel was not tested for explosive or thermite residues.

[14] **Newsday: Heightened Security Alert Had Just Been Lifted**. Curtis L. Taylor and Sean Gardiner, September 12, 2001. Republished contemporary article quoting guard Daria Coard. The original Newsday archive was not acquired; the mirror preserves a reported statement, not deployment records.

[15] **9/11 Memorial Museum: Sirius police badge accession**. Collection C.2012.586.6, gift of Lt. David W. Lim. Museum provenance and account document the bomb-detection dog and handler in the South Tower basement on September 11.

[16] **Willie Brown got low-key early warning about air travel**. Matier and Ross, San Francisco Chronicle/SFGate, September 12, 2001. Contemporary reporting; does not identify Rice as caller or report a specific 9/11 warning.

[17] **9/11 Commission hearing: John Ashcroft testimony**. April 13, 2004, official transcript mirrored by the University of North Texas. See exchange with Richard Ben-Veniste about official versus personal commercial air travel. Testimony is not an independent manifest audit.

[18] **SEC Chairman Harvey Pitt: condition of financial markets after the attacks**. September 20, 2001 Senate Banking testimony. Primary contemporaneous account of SEC electronic-document recovery and case reconstruction; not a final audit of all losses.

[19] **SEC Office of Inspector General semiannual report**. Reporting period ending October 31, 2001. Primary oversight record; printed p. 13 discusses interruption, recovery of lost evidence and resumption of audits.

[20] **Reuters: Buried WTC gold returns to futures trade**. November 17, 2001, Reuters report republished by Rediff. Quotes the November 16 NYBOT/ScotiaMocatta recovery and relocation statement. This is institutional reporting, not independent verification of every vault inventory.

[21] **UPI: Report bin Laden treated at U.S. hospital**. October 31, 2001. Contemporary account of the Le Figaro allegation and its anonymous sourcing. Establishes publication, not truth of the alleged meeting.

[22] **UPI: CIA denies meeting with bin Laden**. October 31, 2001. Indexed article text records CIA and hospital denials; direct page retrieval was blocked. No underlying hospital or travel record was acquired.

[23] **PolitiFact: BBC reporting error is not proof of participation in 9/11**. December 16, 2021. Secondary reporting tracing the BBC/Reuters explanation. Original BBC blog pages were blocked and the Reuters wire sequence was not independently acquired during this review.

[24] **University of Alaska Fairbanks: A Structural Reevaluation of the Collapse of WTC 7**. J. Leroy Hulsey, Feng Xiao and Zhili Quan; final report March 2020. Primary institutional project description, funding disclosure and links to report and data. The large final PDF exceeded the retrieval limit; no model was rerun for this review.

[25] **Harrit et al.: Active Thermitic Material Discovered in Dust from the 9/11 World Trade Center Catastrophe**. The Open Chemical Physics Journal 2 (2009), pp. 7-31. DOI 10.2174/1874412500902010007. Original paper; see sample provenance, methods and discussion section 6 on heating in air. Publication establishes a scientific claim, not its successful independent replication.

[26] **James R. Millette: Revised Progress Report on Red/Gray Chips in WTC Dust**. MVA Scientific Consultants report MVA9119, March 1, 2012, superseding February 29. Original laboratory report on a third-party mirror; particularly pp. 1 and 3-5. Uses different samples from Harrit et al.; not a same-sample replication.

[27] **FEMA 403 Appendix C: Limited Metallurgical Examination**. Jonathan Barnett, Ronald R. Biederman and R. D. Sisson Jr., May 2002. Primary report hosted by NIST. See C-1 on provenance and localized melting, C-5 on the first sample, and C-13 on unresolved source, timing and further research.

[28] **BBC Trust Editorial Standards Committee: November 2007 appeals bulletin**. Primary editorial proceeding. Printed p. 39 reports the programme-makers' account of Silverstein's explanation. Statements of complainants elsewhere in the bulletin must not be mistaken for findings.

[29] **DOT Inspector General: Results of Investigation of 9/11 Commission Staff Referral**. August 31, 2006, CC-2006-085. Primary oversight report, especially Results in Brief and discussion of Flight 77 notification, liaison participation and uncorrected statements. Reports serious inaccuracies and recommended administrative action without finding evidence of intentional falsehood.

[30] **Flight 93 National Memorial: Phone Calls from Flight 93**. National Park Service chronology with references to FBI interviews, trial exhibits and Commission records. Distinguishes recorded calls, billing information and retrospective witness accounts; 35 Airfone calls among 37 total calls.

[31] **DOT Inspector General: Review of the Destruction of an FAA Audiotape**. May 4, 2004, CC-2004-003. Primary investigation of the destruction of six controllers' supplemental recollections recorded on September 11. Distinguishes that tape from operational air-traffic recordings.

[32] **9/11 Commission hearing: Norman Mineta testimony**. May 23, 2003. Primary transcript; exchanges with Lee Hamilton and Timothy Roemer distinguish what Mineta heard, his inference about shootdown orders and his estimate of the time.

[33] **NTSB: Flight Path Study, American Airlines Flight 77**. February 19, 2002, DCA01MA064; aircraft N644AA. Primary five-page study integrating flight-data-recorder and radar data.

[34] **NIST: Pentagon Building Performance Study (2001)**. NIST summary of the ASCE investigation. Describes site examination, structural damage and evidence reviewed; this summary is not the complete ASCE technical report.

[35] **Pentagon 9/11: Defense Department official history**. 2007. Primary institutional history; relevant recovery discussion at printed pp. 159-161. Describes aircraft fragments and recovery and condition of the two flight recorders. Relevant sections examined, not a cover-to-cover review.

[36] **Flight 93 National Memorial: Frequently Asked Questions**. National Park Service account of the wreckage, recorder recovery and debris distribution. Distinguishes heavy crash-site wreckage from light debris carried farther away.

[37] **Flight 93 cockpit voice recorder transcript**. Primary transcript released as trial evidence and hosted by the National Park Service. Relevant struggle and descent dialogue appears in the closing pages. The sealed original audio was not heard in this review.

[38] **Department of Justice: Aboard Flight 93**. DOJ artifact record identifies a recovered fuselage fragment with cockpit number 5491, used in positive aircraft identification.

[39] **Allen M. Poteshman: Unusual Option Market Activity and the Terrorist Attacks of September 11, 2001**. Journal of Business 79(4), July 2006, pp. 1703-1726; DOI 10.1086/503645. Original published paper on a third-party mirror, bibliographic details checked against JSTOR. See introduction and conclusion for the differing results of volume ratios and abnormal long-put volume.

[40] **SEC: Statement Concerning Terrorist Attack Trading Investigation**. July 22, 2004, release 2004-98. Primary statement of investigative scope and findings; does not itself publish the transaction workpapers.

[41] **Commission staff Monograph on Terrorist Financing**. John Roth, Douglas Greenburg and Serena Wille, 2004. Primary report archived by UNT; printed p. 148 describes the September 6 United options position and the same adviser's American Airlines purchase.

[42] **House hearing: Results of the Defense Department Fiscal Year 1999 Financial Statements Audit**. May 9, 2000, serial 106-200. Primary congressional record; see Robert J. Lieberman's statement, especially printed p. 9, on $2.3 trillion of unsupported accounting adjustments.

[43] **Joint Chiefs of Staff: Justification for U.S. Military Intervention in Cuba**. March 13, 1962 Northwoods memorandum. Declassified primary document hosted by the National Security Archive, with linked document/OCR. Planning proposals must be distinguished from execution.

[44] **PNAC: Rebuilding America's Defenses**. September 2000. Original report on a faculty-site mirror. Printed p. 51 contains the Pearl Harbor analogy in its military-transformation context; the document also distinguishes its institutional view from participants' individual views.

[45] **World Trade Center Properties v. Hartford Fire Insurance, 345 F.3d 154**. Second Circuit, September 26, 2003. Primary opinion on a legal archive. Background discusses lease-required coverage, insurance binders, loss and the occurrence dispute. It does not establish a net-profit figure.

[46] **DOJ Inspector General: FBI review, chapter five**. Review of the FBI's Handling of Intelligence Information Related to the September 11 Attacks, November 2004; public unclassified version June 2006. Chapter on al-Mihdhar and al-Hazmi, missed opportunities and limits on access to CIA records.

[47] **August 6, 2001 Presidential Daily Brief**. Declassified primary document, Bin Ladin Determined To Strike in US, hosted by the National Security Archive. Warning content must be distinguished from knowledge of the complete September 11 operation.

[48] **FBI Announces List of 19 Hijackers**. September 14, 2001. Original public identification release; includes aliases and varying biographical detail. Useful for reconstructing early reporting rather than assuming it was the final evidence record.

[49] **DOJ Inspector General: FBI review, chapter six**. Overall conclusions of the same review, including failures relating to the Phoenix memorandum, Moussaoui and al-Mihdhar/al-Hazmi.

[50] **Flight 93 National Memorial: Cockpit Voice Recorder**. National Park Service chronology of recovery, examination, family access and release of the transcript. Distinguishes the public transcript from original audio not publicly released.

[51] **FBI Laboratory: 75 Years of Forensic Science Service, page 2**. Forensic Science Communications 9(4), October 2007. Institutional forensic account describes hijacker DNA profiles from crash-site and hotel items, document examination and recordings.

[52] **FBI: 9/11 Investigation**. Institutional summary of the investigation and attribution to al-Qaeda. Used with the specific underlying records in this review, rather than as a substitute for them.